

**D.J. PARIS**

# 15 HOURS.

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The average agent's real lead response time. Here's what that costs.

**D.J. Paris**  
Keeping It Real Podcast

**kale**  
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**WHOEVER  
ANSWERS FIRST  
GETS THE BUYER.**

Seventy-eight percent of buyers end up working with whoever responds to their inquiry first.



# THE LEAD ISN'T COLD. YOU JUST SHOWED UP LATE.

Inman's 2025 Real Estate Technology Survey put the average agent's lead response time at 917 minutes, over fifteen hours. NAR's 2025 Home Buyers and Sellers Generational Trends Report found most buyers work with the first agent who responds, not the most experienced one or the one with the best marketing. The lead didn't disappear. Somebody else picked up the phone while it was still warm.



# WHAT CHANGES TODAY:

- 1 Set a five-minute alarm on every lead source.**  
Portal leads, CRM leads, website leads. The alarm is the system. Your memory isn't.
- 2 Send a text before you dial.**  
A short "got your inquiry, calling in two minutes" message holds their attention while you're getting to the phone.
- 3 Check last week's response times once.**  
The fifteen-hour average includes agents who think they're already fast. Look at your own number before assuming you beat it.



## THE TAKEAWAY

**SPEED IS THE  
LISTING  
PRESENTATION  
NOBODY SEES YOU  
GIVE.**

Answer in five minutes. The other fourteen hours and fifty-five were never actually available to you.